

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Ratios, rates, proportional relationships, and units	Medium

Question

At a particular track meet, the ratio of coaches to athletes is **1** to **26**. If there are x coaches at the track meet, which of the following expressions represents the number of athletes at the track meet?

Answer

- A. $\frac{x}{26}$
- B. $26x$
- C. $x + 26$
- D. $\frac{26}{x}$

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. It’s given that at a particular track meet, the ratio of coaches to athletes is **1** to **26**. If one number in a ratio is multiplied by a value, the other number must be multiplied by the same value in order to maintain the same ratio. If there are x coaches at the track meet, multiplying both numbers in the ratio by x yields **1**(x) to **26**(x), or x to **26** x . Therefore, the expression **26** x represents the number of athletes at the track meet.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.